

Chez Fifi • By the Glass

Complete BTG Packet

Descriptions • Dessert Wine • Server Study Guide • Answer Key

BTG DESCRIPTIONS — SUMMARY

SPARKLING

Cava — Avinyó, 'Reserva Brut' | 2022 · Penedès, Catalonia, Spain | \$18

Organic, old-vine traditional-method Cava — creamy, brioche-tinged, with white peach and saline minerality.

Champagne — Michel Gonet, 'Les 3 Terroirs' Blanc de Blancs Extra Brut | 2020 · Côte des Blancs, Champagne, France | \$45

100% Chardonnay from three Grand Cru terroirs — crisp, mineral-driven, with citrus, hazelnut, and chalky depth.

Rosé Champagne — Laurent-Perrier, 'Cuvée Rosé' Brut | NV · Montagne de Reims, Champagne, France | \$48

The world's benchmark rosé Champagne — saignée-macerated Grand Cru Pinot Noir, supple and fruit-driven with wild raspberry and rose petal.

Champagne — Laurent-Perrier, 'Ultra Brut' Brut Nature | NV · Montagne de Reims, Champagne, France | \$42

Pioneer of zero-dosage Champagne since 1981 — bone-dry and mineral, revealing pure Chardonnay-Pinot Noir terroir with no sugar added.

Champagne — Laurent-Perrier, 'Grand Siècle No. 26' Brut | NV (Blend of 2012, 2008, 2007) · Montagne de Reims, Champagne, France | \$95

A prestige blend of three vintages from eight Grand Crus — richly layered, silky, and precise, Champagne's answer to the 'perfect year.'

WHITE

Muscadet — Luneau-Papin, 'La Grange' Sèvre-et-Maine | 2023 · Le Landreau, Loire Valley, France | \$18

Biodynamic single-parcel Muscadet — saline, mineral, and textured with oyster shell and crushed stone.

Sancerre — Pascal & Nicolas Reverdy, 'Les Côûtes' | 2025 · Maimbray, Loire Valley, France | \$30

Old-vine Kimmeridgian Sancerre — dense, chalky, with citrus, white peach, and mouthwatering mineral grip.

Albariño — Manuel Moldes, 'Afelio' | 2024 · Val do Salnés, Rías Baixas, Galicia, Spain | \$25

Granite-driven Albariño — racy, saline, and electric, with salt spray and white peach.

Chenin Blanc — François Chidaine, 'Les Argiles' | 2024 · Vouvray (bottled in Montlouis), Loire Valley, France | \$28

Biodynamic dry Chenin from top Vouvray clay plots (labeled Vin de France due to an AOC quirk) — bone-dry, chalky, mineral-focused.

Chablis — Clément Lavallée, '45°' | 2023 · Chablis, Burgundy, France | \$48

Single Kimmeridgian parcel on a 45-degree slope — pure, stony, and precise, with strong aging potential.

ROSÉ

Rosé — Ameztoi, 'Rubentis' Getariako Txakolina | 2025 · Getaria, Basque Country, Spain | \$19

The original rosé Txakoli — pale, lightly spritzy, low-alcohol, with sour strawberry and sea-breeze salinity.

Rosé — Chêne Bleu, 'Le Rosé' Vaucluse | 2024 · Dentelles de Montmirail, Vaucluse, Rhône, France | \$28

High-altitude biodynamic Rhône rosé with Bandol-like structure — creamy, mineral, built for the table.

RED

Garnacha — Vitícola Mentrídana, 'El Mentrídano' | 2022 · Méntrida, Sierra de Gredos, Spain | \$20

Burgundian-styled old-vine Garnacha — floral, light-footed, with delicate tannin and savory lift.

Pinot Noir — Faiveley, 'Les Montroziers' Nuits-Saint-Georges | 2022 · Côte de Nuits, Burgundy, France | \$55

Village Nuits with Vosne-leaning elegance — silky, perfumed Pinot with raspberry, peony, and graphite.

Châteauneuf-du-Pape — Croze-Granier, 'Ancien Domaine de Pontifès' | 2023 · Châteauneuf-du-Pape, Rhône, France | \$38

Classically built organic CDP — old-vine Grenache with garrigue, black cherry, and structured savory depth.

Bordeaux — Vieux Château Champs de Mars | 2003 · Castillon Côtes de Bordeaux, France | \$40

Biodynamic right-bank Bordeaux at full maturity — dried plum, cedar, leather, and silky tannins.

Tempranillo — Vizcarra, 'Senda del Oro' | 2024 · Ribera del Duero, Castilla y León, Spain | \$22

Modern, restrained high-elevation Ribera — juicy dark berry, violets, and fresh acidity without heavy oak.

BTG DESCRIPTIONS — FULL DETAIL

Cava — Avinyó, 'Reserva Brut' | \$18

2022 · Penedès, Catalonia, Spain · Certified Organic

Grapes: 60% Xarel·lo, 25% Macabeo, 15% Parellada

Method: Méthode Traditionnelle · 18–24 months on lees · 11.5% ABV

TASTING NOTES

Ripe apple, lemon peel, white flowers, and toasted almond on the nose. Creamy palate with fine mousse, white peach, and saline minerality. Dry finish with a touch of brioche.

WINERY PROFILE

4th-generation Esteve family estate in Avinyonet del Penedès, farming since 1597. In 2022, earned the Elaborador Integral designation — Cava's equivalent of Champagne's Récoltant-Manipulant — held by only 14 producers in the D.O.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

All vineyards certified organic. Old vines (planted 1978–1988) at 250–275m on clay-calcareous soils. Hand-harvested at night, gently pressed, aged on the lees well beyond the legal minimum. Disgorged on demand.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

Avinyó's flagship — vintage-dated, made from free-run juice only. Xarel·lo provides backbone and earthiness; Macabeo adds floral lift; Parellada brings acidity and elegance.

VINTAGE DETAILS

2022 was warm and dry in Penedès. High-elevation old vines and organic farming preserved freshness.

Champagne — Michel Gonet, 'Les 3 Terroirs' Blanc de Blancs Extra Brut | \$45

2020 · Côte des Blancs, Champagne, France · Sustainable

Grapes: 100% Chardonnay

Method: Méthode Champenoise · Extended lees aging · 2 g/L dosage · 12.5% ABV

TASTING NOTES

Lemon, green apple, pear, and white peach on the nose, followed by hazelnut, toasted almond, and brioche from extended lees aging. Crisp and focused on the palate, with fine persistent bubbles, chalky minerality, and a clean, long finish.

WINERY PROFILE

Founded in 1802 by Charles Gonet, the Maison is still family-owned — now managed by Sophie Gonet (7th generation). The estate owns 40+ hectares in the Côte des Blancs, including parcels in the Grand Cru villages of Avize, Oger, and Le Mesnil sur Oger, and into the hills of Sézanne and Vindey.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Sustainable viticulture across 40 hectares of primarily Chardonnay. Extended aging on the lees gives the wines depth and textural complexity. Low dosage (2 g/L) keeps the profile precise and mineral.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

A blend of Chardonnay from three distinct terroirs: Le Mesnil sur Oger (Grand Cru chalk, tension), Montgueux (cool, citrus-driven), and Vindey in the Sézannais (rounder, fleshier texture). The three sites together produce a complexity no single terroir could achieve.

VINTAGE DETAILS

2020 was a warm, generous Champagne vintage with strong ripeness balanced by enough acidity for structure. Extended élevage integrates toasty, nutty secondary notes and softens Chardonnay's natural acidity into a seamless, refined whole.

Rosé Champagne — Laurent-Perrier, 'Cuvée Rosé' Brut | \$48

NV · Montagne de Reims, Champagne, France

Grapes: 100% Pinot Noir (10 Grand Cru crus, including Ambonnay, Bouzy, Louvois, and Tours-sur-Marne)

Method: Saignée maceration (48–72 hrs) · 5 years on lees · 8 g/L dosage

TASTING NOTES

Pomegranate, dark cherry, blood orange, and bergamot on the nose, with a hint of Sichuan pepper. Medium-to-full-bodied and vinous on the palate, with a frothy mousse and ripe, vibrant acidity. Long, perfumed finish.

WINERY PROFILE

Founded in 1812, Laurent-Perrier reached its golden age under Bernard de Nonancourt starting in 1948. Built around the freshness of Chardonnay, the Maison is today one of the largest family-controlled Champagne houses, based in Tours-sur-Marne.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Destemmed Pinot Noir grapes macerate on their skins for 48 to 72 hours to extract color and aroma, then the juice is drawn off and fermented separately — the saignée method. The non-vintage blend combines roughly equal parts base-year and reserve wine, resting 5 years on the lees.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

Launched in 1968 by Bernard de Nonancourt, Cuvée Rosé pioneered the modern rosé Champagne category and remains the world's best-selling rosé Champagne. Sourced from 10 Grand Cru villages across the Montagne de Reims, including Bouzy, Ambonnay, Louvois, and Tours-sur-Marne.

VINTAGE DETAILS

Non-vintage assemblage built on a roughly 50/50 base-year and reserve-wine blend. The current release, based on the 2019 vintage, shows pomegranate and dark cherry richness balanced by vibrant acidity.

Champagne — Laurent-Perrier, 'Ultra Brut' Brut Nature | \$42

NV · Montagne de Reims, Champagne, France

Grapes: ~55% Chardonnay, 45% Pinot Noir (blend of 15 Grand and Premier Cru crus)

Method: Zero dosage · No added sugar · 6 years on lees

TASTING NOTES

Pale straw-yellow with a fine bead. Intense citrus and honeysuckle on the nose with a distinctive mineral edge. Balanced and sustained on the palate, with pear and grapefruit through to a fresh, lemony finish.

WINERY PROFILE

Introduced in 1981 under Bernard de Nonancourt, Ultra Brut revived the House's 19th-century “Grand Vin Sans Sucre,” a sugar-free style first crafted in 1889 for British clients. Laurent-Perrier remains one of the last houses producing true zero-dosage Champagne at this level.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Only grapes from very ripe harvests with a naturally balanced sugar-to-acid ratio are selected, since no dosage corrects for imbalance at full dryness. The blend draws on 15 crus and rests at least 6 years on the lees, topped at disgorgement with reserve wine rather than dosage.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

Ultra Brut is Champagne stripped to its essentials — no added sugar of any kind, revealing the intrinsic character of the Chardonnay-Pinot Noir blend and the chalk soils beneath it. A versatile, bone-dry style built for oysters and sushi.

VINTAGE DETAILS

A non-vintage blend built only from exceptionally ripe years, since the sugar-acid balance needed without dosage depends on harvest quality. The result is a consistently dry, mineral house style unique to Laurent-Perrier.

Champagne — Laurent-Perrier, 'Grand Siècle No. 26' Brut | \$95

NV (Blend of 2012, 2008, 2007) · Montagne de Reims, Champagne, France

Grapes: 58% Chardonnay, 42% Pinot Noir · 100% Grand Cru (8 crus)

Method: Blend of 65% 2012, 25% 2008, 10% 2007 · 10 years on lees · 7 g/L dosage

TASTING NOTES

White gold in color with fine, persistent bubbles. Honeysuckle, lemon, clementine, and fresh butter on the nose, with hazelnut and a touch of honey. Silky and mineral on the palate, with candied lemon and flaked almond through a long, precise finish.

WINERY PROFILE

Grand Siècle was born from Bernard de Nonancourt's vision to recreate, through blending, a “perfect year” that no single vintage could deliver alone. Named for Louis XIV's Great Century and bottled in a replica 17th-century flask, it is Laurent-Perrier's prestige cuvée.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Fruit is drawn exclusively from eight of Champagne's top-rated Grand Cru villages, including Le Mesnil-sur-Oger, Cramant, Avize, Oger, Ambonnay, Bouzy, and Verzy. Each vintage is vinified and aged separately before blending, then rests a further 10 years on the lees.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

Now in its 26th release since 1959, Grand Siècle is never a single-vintage wine — three complementary vintage years are blended to “create” the ideal year nature alone rarely provides. One of the few prestige cuvées built around a Chardonnay-dominant blend.

VINTAGE DETAILS

This iteration blends 65% 2012, 25% 2008, and 10% 2007 — three of the most celebrated Champagne vintages of the 21st century. Disgorged in 2023 after a decade on the lees, showing the generosity of 2012 tempered by 2008's structure.

Muscadet — Luneau-Papin, 'La Grange' Sèvre-et-Maine | \$18

2023 · Le Landreau, Loire Valley, France · Certified Organic & Biodynamic

Grapes: 100% Melon de Bourgogne

Method: Hand-harvested · Native yeast · 6 months sur lie in concrete/glass-tile tanks

TASTING NOTES

Pale lemon with green reflections. Lime zest, green apple, and white peach, with crushed oyster shell, wet stone, and a light floral edge. Mineral-driven and textured on the palate — saline, round, with a dry, refreshing finish.

WINERY PROFILE

9th-generation family farming Muscadet since the late 17th century. Pierre-Marie and Marie Luneau have transformed the estate through certified biodynamics and a focus on single-parcel terroir bottlings. Widely considered one of the top producers in the appellation.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Certified organic (Ecocert, 2013) and biodynamic (Demeter & Biodyvin, 2019). 27 hectares farmed without synthetic products. Whole-cluster pressing, ambient yeast fermentation, 6 months sur lie in underground concrete tanks lined with glass tile. No racking, no fining, no filtration. Minimal SO₂ at bottling.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

From 35-year-old vines (planted 1974) on mica-schist and shale soils in Le Landreau. La Grange is the rounder, fleshier of the estate's two village wines — built on texture and depth rather than the firmer, more linear Le Verger.

VINTAGE DETAILS

2023 in Muscadet delivered freshness and purity — well-balanced acidity, ripe but precise. La Grange shows notable roundness and flesh in this vintage.

Sancerre — Pascal & Nicolas Reverdy, 'Les Côûtes' | \$30

2025 · Maimbray, Loire Valley, France · Sustainable

Grapes: 100% Sauvignon Blanc

Method: Hand-harvested at 45 hl/ha · Stainless steel fermentation & aging · Unfiltered

TASTING NOTES

Dense and textured for Sancerre. Citrus zest, white peach, and gooseberry over crushed chalk and shell minerality. Full-bodied and precise on the palate — integrated mineral grip, phenolic structure, and a long, saline, mouthwatering finish.

WINERY PROFILE

Based in the hamlet of Maimbray — a chalk-cliffed valley adjacent to Chavignol and Verdigny. Founded by brothers Pascal and Nicolas (Nicolas passed in 2005), now run by Pascal and his sons Victorien and Benjamin, who trained at Domaine Rousseau and Romanée-Conti respectively.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Sustainable viticulture with restricted yields. Hand-harvested, each plot fermented separately in stainless steel. Lees aging through winter, spring bottling, unfiltered.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

A single hillside plot of 50+ year-old vines on Kimmeridgian Marne — the same Terre Blanche bedrock as the great wines of Chavignol. Yields restricted to 45 hl/ha, stainless steel only, bottled unfiltered.

VINTAGE DETAILS

2025 brought freshness and clarity to Sancerre. Reverdy's old-vine Kimmeridgian fruit captures the year's tension and salinity well.

Albariño — Manuel Moldes, 'Afelio' | \$25

2024 · Val do Salnés, Rías Baixas, Galicia, Spain · Organic / Biodynamic (uncertified)

Grapes: 100% Albariño

Method: Native yeast · Stainless steel + neutral French oak · 9–11 months on lees

TASTING NOTES

Salt spray, white peach, lemon, and Atlantic air on the nose. Taut, saline, and finely cut on the palate, with vibrant citrus and stone fruit framed by granite-driven minerality and brisk acidity. Long, savory finish.

WINERY PROFILE

Manuel “Chicho” Moldes launched his eponymous label in 2017 alongside his work as winemaker at Bodegas Fulcro. One of the leading figures of the new-wave Galician scene, focused on small-parcel, terroir-driven Albariños highlighting the contrast between schist and granite sites.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Organic and biodynamic in practice (uncertified). Tiny parcels across the heart of Val do Salnés between Meaño and Cambados. Vines averaging 50+ years old on the traditional pergola system on granite posts. Native fermentation in stainless steel and old French oak (500–700L) at 21°C max.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

A blend of up to 20 small parcels on granite bedrock — a counterpoint to Moldes's schist-based bottlings. The granite signature shows in the wine's tension, lift, and acidic spine.

VINTAGE DETAILS

2024 drinking with characteristic Salnés freshness and salinity.

Chenin Blanc — François Chidaine, 'Les Argiles' | \$28

2024 · Vouvray (bottled in Montlouis), Loire Valley, France · Certified Biodynamic

Grapes: 100% Chenin Blanc

Method: Hand-harvested · Native yeast · No malolactic · Aged in 600L demi-muids on lees

TASTING NOTES

Bone-dry but textured — beeswax and fresh cream around honeydew, pear, and golden apple. Precise and high-intensity on the palate, with crushed rock, chalk, and lime zest cutting through a creamy mid-palate. Bracing acidity, long mineral finish.

WINERY PROFILE

François Chidaine is widely regarded as the leading Chenin Blanc producer in Montlouis and Vouvray. He has grown the domaine from 4 hectares (inherited in 1989) to 45 hectares and holds the highest rating of any Loire producer from La Revue du Vin de France (one of only seven). Absent from the Vouvray AOC since 2014 — see below.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Certified organic since 1992, biodynamic (Demeter) since 1999. Whole-cluster pressing, native yeast, no malolactic, 8–11 months on lees in 600L demi-muids, unfiltered, minimal sulfur.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

100% from clay-rich Vouvray plots around the legendary Clos Baudoin. 40-year-old bush vines on chalky clay over limestone. Because Chidaine's cellar is in Montlouis, the AOC has barred him from labeling these wines Vouvray since 2014 — they are sold as Vin de France.

VINTAGE DETAILS

2024 brought a return to Loire freshness after several warmer vintages. Chidaine's biodynamic farming produced wines of characteristic poise and mineral precision.

Chablis — Clément Lavallée, '45°' | \$48

2023 · Chablis, Burgundy, France · Organic (uncertified)

Grapes: 100% Chardonnay

Method: Native yeast · Stainless steel · 18 months on lees · Unfiltered

TASTING NOTES

Lemon zest, lime, crisp green apple, and white peach, with subtle orchard fruit, fresh butter, and mineral salinity. Taut and precise on the palate with chalky, crystalline acidity and a clean, long finish. Pure, stony Chablis built for aging.

WINERY PROFILE

Clément Lavallée launched his own label in 2019 after working across Burgundy (Armand Heitz, Domaine des Terres de Velle), Château Margaux, Domaine Chapoutier, and Rutherglen, Australia. He now farms 14 hectares across Chablis, Côtes d'Auxerre, and Saint-Bris. His neighbors in Courgis include Thomas Pico (Pattes Loup) and Domaine De Moor.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Organic in practice (uncertified) — no herbicides, no chemicals, gravity-flow cellar, native yeast, no sulfur during pressing. Aged 18 months on lees in stainless steel to preserve the site's mineral character without oxidative influence.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

Named for the 45-degree gradient of the Kimmeridgian parcel from which it comes — the label is applied to the bottle at the same angle. From Courgis on the left bank of the Serein. Very limited production.

VINTAGE DETAILS

2023 in Chablis delivered freshness and balance — precise acidity and ripe but clean fruit. Lavallée's minimal-intervention approach lets the vintage's purity come through directly.

Rosé — Ameztoi, 'Rubentis' Getariako Txakolina | \$19

2025 · Getaria, Basque Country, Spain · Sustainable

Grapes: 50% Hondarribi Beltza, 50% Hondarribi Zuri (field blend, co-fermented)

Method: Native yeast in stainless steel · 3-week co-fermentation · Bottle-conditioned residual CO₂ · ~11.5% ABV

TASTING NOTES

Pale pink with fuchsia tints and a fine, persistent natural spritz. Citrus zest, sour strawberry, wild berry, and herbal menthol on the nose. Light, zesty, and saline on the palate — tangy red fruit and crisp green apple lifted by a playful spritz. Low-alcohol, crisp, mineral finish.

WINERY PROFILE

5th-generation Ameztoi family has farmed cliffside vineyards above the Bay of Biscay in Getaria for over 200 years. They invented the rosé Txakoli style in the 2000s when most growers were removing their red Hondarribi Beltza vines. Ameztoi preserved theirs — including a planting from 1840.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Ecological farming on 20 hectares of sea-facing slopes between 50 and 200m elevation on limestone soils. Hand-harvested. White and red grapes destemmed and co-fermented together for 3 weeks in refrigerated stainless with native yeasts. Bottled with residual fermentation carbonation — never force-carbonated.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

Rubentis was the first rosé Txakoli produced — inspired by historic claret-style wines once made on the Basque coast. The old Hondarribi Beltza vines (some from 1840) give the wine its color, structure, and tannic backbone.

VINTAGE DETAILS

A young, just-released vintage drinking at full Atlantic-fresh, spritzy expression.

Rosé — Chêne Bleu, 'Le Rosé' Vaucluse | \$28

2024 · Dentelles de Montmirail, Vaucluse, Rhône, France · Certified Organic / Biodynamic

Grapes: 60% Grenache, 20% Syrah, 14% Mourvèdre, 6% Rolle (Vermentino)

Method: Direct press · Native yeast in stainless · 25% aged in French oak · Lees-stirred

TASTING NOTES

Pale salmon-peach. Wild strawberry, raspberry, and cherry on the nose, with lemon peel, jasmine, and crushed stone. Creamy and full-bodied for a rosé — good salinity, citrus core, and a long, mineral finish. Decanter compared it to Domaine Tempier Bandol.

WINERY PROFILE

Chêne Bleu sits at the four-corner intersection of Gigondas, Côtes du Ventoux, Côtes du Rhône, and Séguret in the Dentelles de Montmirail. The Rolet family acquired the abandoned medieval estate (a former Knights Templar priory) in 1994 and opted out of the AOC system entirely to pursue full quality freedom.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Certified organic and biodynamic at 530–630m elevation — the highest vineyard in the southern Rhône. Cool-climate altitude with clay, limestone, and stone soils. Hand-harvested, double-sorted. Direct press for the rosé, slow cool fermentation, 25% in barrel for texture.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

A food rosé built for ageability. High altitude preserves the acidity and structure most southern French rosés lack. The Mourvèdre and Syrah components provide the Bandol-like backbone.

VINTAGE DETAILS

2024 delivered good freshness in the southern Rhône — cooler nights at altitude preserved acidity and aromatic precision.

Garnacha — Vitícola Mentrídana, 'El Mentrídano' | \$20

2022 · Méntrida, Sierra de Gredos, Spain · Organic (uncertified)

Grapes: 100% Garnacha

Method: Whole-cluster, native yeast in open-top oak vats · Short maceration · 7 months in 30/37 hL French oak foudres · Unfiltered

TASTING NOTES

Pale ruby. Floral aromatics of dark cherry, wild strawberry, dried herbs, and violet. Light-footed on the palate with delicate tannins, mineral lift, and a fresh, savory finish. More Burgundian in weight and feel than Spanish.

WINERY PROFILE

Vitícola Mentrídana is the continuation of the Méntrida vineyards of Daniel Landi (Comando G) — handed in 2021 to childhood friend Curro Barreño. Curro previously worked at Fedellos do Couto in Galicia making light, precise reds. A Gredos native, he's returned to build on Landi's foundation.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Old-vine Garnacha at 600m on sandy granitic soils. Organic farming, hand-harvested, whole-cluster fermented in open-top oak vats with native yeasts. Short maceration for gentle extraction. 7 months in large neutral French oak foudres. No filtration, no stabilization.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

The village-level wine — Curro's family Garnacha vines around Méntrida. More accessible and drinkable than the higher-altitude Las Uvas de la Ira (850m) and single-vineyard Cantos del Diablo.

VINTAGE DETAILS

2022 was warmer in Gredos. Short macerations and whole-cluster work kept the wine light, floral, and fresh despite the heat.

Pinot Noir — Faiveley, 'Les Montrozier' Nuits-Saint-Georges | \$55

2022 · Côte de Nuits, Burgundy, France · Organic (uncertified)

Grapes: 100% Pinot Noir

Method: Hand-harvested · 14 months in French oak (20% new) · 2 months in tank before bottling

TASTING NOTES

Intense garnet. Raspberry, black cherry, plum, and peony on the nose, with forest floor, sweet spice, and graphite. Smooth and perfumed on the palate — velvety tannins, lively acidity, medium-long finish. More Vosne-Romanée in character than typical Nuits.

WINERY PROFILE

Founded in 1825, Domaine Faiveley is one of Burgundy's largest family domaines — 7th generation under Erwan Faiveley and his sister Eve. They own 120 hectares including 12 Grands Crus and 25 Premiers Crus across the Côte d'Or and Côte Chalonnaise.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

The 4.84-hectare Montrozier parcels are farmed organically (uncertified). Vine ages range from 1928 plantings to more recent additions on east-facing clay-limestone soils. Erwan Faiveley has moved toward more precision and freshness since 2005. 14 months in fine-grained French oak (20% new), then 2 months tank rest before bottling.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

Named for Maurice Colrat de Montrozier, witness to the 1945 Faiveley family marriage. Previously two separate parcellaire bottlings (Aux Lavières and Les Argillats), now blended into one village cuvée — the fruit leaning toward the Vosne-Romanée side of Nuits.

VINTAGE DETAILS

2022 was a strong Burgundy vintage — generous and ripe, with acidity preserved by cooler nights. Montrozier shows the vintage's balance and purity. Supple now with a decant, but built for 5–10 years.

Châteauneuf-du-Pape — Croze-Granier, 'Ancien Domaine de Pontifès' | \$38

2023 · Châteauneuf-du-Pape, Rhône, France · Certified Organic

Grapes: ~80% Grenache, ~20% Mourvèdre (with permitted blending varieties)

Method: Hand-harvested · Old vines · Traditional vinification · ~15% ABV

TASTING NOTES

Deep Châteauneuf garnet. Black cherry, blackberry, garrigue (thyme, rosemary, lavender), warm earth, black pepper, and licorice on the nose. Powerful and balanced on the palate — concentrated fruit, structured tannins, ripe mid-palate, long savory finish.

WINERY PROFILE

5th-generation family domaine producing wine in the southern Rhône since 1895, across Châteauneuf-du-Pape, Lirac, and Côtes du Rhône. 4 hectares within Châteauneuf and 16 hectares in Roquemaure. The name “Ancien Domaine des Pontifès” references the property's historic ties to the Avignon papacy.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Certified organic since 2012 (Ecocert) — no chemical inputs, limited mechanical soil work, minimal sulfites. Cellar in Roquemaure is built into a stone cliff (L'Escatillon), giving exceptional thermal stability year-round.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

The estate's flagship Châteauneuf-du-Pape — old-vine Grenache supported by Mourvèdre. Classically structured rather than modern in style.

VINTAGE DETAILS

2023 in the southern Rhône produced wines with good freshness alongside typical ripeness — a balanced vintage drinking with notable elegance for Châteauneuf.

Bordeaux — Vieux Château Champs de Mars | \$40

2003 · Castillon Côtes de Bordeaux, France · Certified Organic / Biodynamic

Grapes: 80% Merlot, 20% Cabernet Franc

Method: Hand-harvested · Native yeast · Aged in neutral oak · Unfined, unfiltered

TASTING NOTES

Deep garnet with a brick-orange rim. Dried plum, blackcurrant, cedar, tobacco, leather, and forest floor on the nose. Silky and balanced on the palate with softened tannins, dried fruit, a spiced finish, and lingering mineral edge. Fully mature right-bank Bordeaux.

WINERY PROFILE

Founded in the early 1980s by Régis Moro, who farmed organically from the outset and used low-intervention cellar work at a time when Bordeaux was moving in the opposite direction. The estate sits in Castillon-Côtes de Bordeaux, a few kilometers from Château Le Puy. The two estates shared a philosophy and a long friendship — the Amoreau (Le Puy) family eventually acquired Champs de Mars, preserving Moro's approach under new ownership.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Certified organic from the start, biodynamic since 2013. 20 hectares on clay-limestone soils. Spontaneous fermentations, no temperature control, no new oak, gravity-flow movement. Bottled without fining or filtration.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

The estate bottling — 80/20 Merlot and Cabernet Franc from sandy clay-limestone terroir in Castillon. At 23 years of age the wine is at a fully mature drinking window, showing the complexity of great farming and patient aging.

VINTAGE DETAILS

2003 was the heat-wave vintage across France. On the right bank, Merlot handled the extreme heat well, producing concentrated, plush wines. After more than two decades, Champs de Mars 2003 is fully integrated — fruit dried and concentrated into complex secondary flavors with silky tannins.

Tempranillo — Vizcarra, 'Senda del Oro' | \$22

2024 · Ribera del Duero, Castilla y León, Spain · Sustainable / Low-Intervention

Grapes: 100% Tinto Fino (Tempranillo)

Method: Hand-harvested · Gravity-flow vinification · 6–7 months in used French & American oak · ~14.5% ABV

TASTING NOTES

Deep ruby-purple. Blackberry, raspberry, and dark cherry with violets, incense, and a floral pastille note that grows spicier with air. Juicy and full-bodied on the palate — concentrated dark fruit, balsamic note, soft tannins, and a fresh acidic core. Modern, restrained Ribera.

WINERY PROFILE

Second-generation family estate in Mambrilla de Castrejón, Burgos subzone — the highest and coolest part of Ribera del Duero. Founded by Juan Carlos Vizcarra in the late 1980s, now run with his daughter Celia. One of the few estates in the region vinifying only estate-grown fruit.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

35+ hectares of estate vines, some over 80 years old, at 800–850m on limestone, clay, and gravel. Hand-harvested, double-sorted, gravity-flow (no pumps). Stainless steel fermentation, malolactic in barrel, 6–7 months in used French and American oak.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

The entry-level cuvée — from the youngest plots (~15 years old) with emphasis on pure fruit over oak influence. The 2024 harvest timing and macerations were adjusted for the warm vintage to maintain freshness.

VINTAGE DETAILS

2024 was warm in Ribera. Juan Carlos and Celia picked earlier and used shorter macerations to preserve fruit and acidity — the new-wave Ribera approach at its most deliberate.

DESSERT WINE — SUMMARY

DESSERT WINE

Rivesaltes Ambré — Domaine de Rancy | 2000 · Roussillon, France | \$20

Organic old-vine Vin Doux Naturel, barrel-aged 21 years — nutty, dried-fruit richness with fig, date, and caramel.

Sauternes — Château Rieussec | 2009 · Bordeaux, France | \$35

Premier Cru Classé Sauternes from a celebrated vintage — honeyed, botrytis-driven richness with citrus and toasted nut.

Sauternes — Château d'Yquem | 1999 · Bordeaux, France | \$180

The world's most legendary sweet wine — 25 years of age revealing roasted chestnut, tarte tatin, and dark honey complexity.

Pineau des Charentes — Lheraud, 'Très Vieux' | 1962 · Cognac, France | \$60

A 60+ year-old vin de liqueur from Cognac — rich and nutty, blending grape must with aged Cognac eau-de-vie.

Port — Kopke, 30 Year Tawny | Douro Valley, Portugal | \$38

From the oldest Port house in the world — a blend averaging 30 years in oak, layered with dried fruit, vanilla, and honey.

Port — Warre's | 1994 · Douro Valley, Portugal | \$40

From a legendary "vintage of the century" — deep and structured, still youthful with black fruit, licorice, and spice.

Madeira — The Rare Wine Co, Boston Bual | Madeira, Portugal | \$25

Part of a historic American-market series — rich, sweet Bual with cinnamon-clove spice and citrus peel complexity.

Madeira — Barbeito, Sercial Reserva Velha | 1898 · Madeira, Portugal | \$175/oz

An extraordinarily rare 19th-century vintage Madeira — bone-dry Sercial with over a century of development.

Madeira — Cossart Gordon, Bual Solera | 1845 · Madeira, Portugal | \$160/oz

A true 19th-century solera dating to 1845 — deep, opulent Bual with toffee, dried fruit, and centuries of history.

Madeira — Barbeito, Malvasia Reserva Velha | 1834 · Madeira, Portugal | \$215/oz

One of the oldest wines in the world available by the glass — a 190-year-old Malvasia of extraordinary depth and refinement.

DESSERT WINE — FULL DETAIL

Rivesaltes Ambré — Domaine de Rancy | \$20

2000 · Roussillon, France · Organic

Grapes: 100% Macabeu (organically farmed)

Method: Vin Doux Naturel — fortified with neutral grape spirit partway through fermentation (mutage) to kill the yeast and lock in natural grape sugar · 21 years in oak, deliberately left unfilled and untopped so air slowly oxidizes the wine · Bottled 2021

TASTING NOTES

Deep amber and oxidative — dried fig, date, toffee, walnut, and caramel, with orange peel and tobacco on a long, warming finish.

WINERY PROFILE

Run by Jean-Hubert and Brigitte Verdaguer, Domaine de Rancy is one of only a handful of estates still producing traditional Ambré-style Rivesaltes in the Roussillon.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Organically farmed old vines. Unlike most wines, oxidation is the point here, not a flaw: barrels sit in ambient (not heated) cellar conditions with an intentional air gap, so the wine slowly "maderizes" over decades — much like a fine oxidative sherry — building nutty, dried-fruit, and rancio complexity while its natural acidity keeps it from turning flat or flabby.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

A Vin Doux Naturel — fortified with neutral grape spirit during fermentation to halt sugar conversion and preserve natural sweetness. This 2000 vintage rested 21 years before bottling in August 2021.

VINTAGE DETAILS

The 2000 vintage is considered one of the estate's standout recent releases.

Sauternes — Château Rieussec | \$35

2009 · Bordeaux, France

Grapes: ~90% Sémillon, ~7% Sauvignon Blanc, ~3% Muscadelle

Method: Hand-harvested over 6–8 weeks in successive tries (passes through the vineyard), picking only berries individually shriveled by noble rot · Fermented and aged in oak barrels 16–26 months

TASTING NOTES

Honeysuckle, tropical fruit, and apricot aromas; rich and layered with marmalade and toasted brioche, finishing long and sweet but beautifully balanced.

WINERY PROFILE

Founded by Carmelite monks in the 18th century, Rieussec has been owned by Domaines Baron de Rothschild (Lafite) since 1984 — one of Sauternes's largest and most prestigious estates, second in stature only to Château d'Yquem.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

93 hectares of gravelly, clay-rich soil. Botrytis cinerea (noble rot) develops unevenly across the vineyard depending on morning fog off the Ciron river, so pickers return repeatedly over weeks, selecting only individual berries at peak shrivel — in poor years, the entire crop can be declassified rather than bottled under the Rieussec name.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

The Grand Vin of Rieussec. 2009 was hailed as an outstanding vintage across Sauternes, among the finest in the estate's modern history.

VINTAGE DETAILS

2009 is considered one of Rieussec's finest vintages, balancing rich botrytis character with vibrant, food-friendly acidity.

Sauternes — Château d'Yquem | \$180

1999 · Bordeaux, France

Grapes: ~80% Sémillon, ~20% Sauvignon Blanc

Method: Up to 5–6 successive tries through the vineyard, hand-picking individual berries only once fully botrytized and raisined — a single vine yields roughly one glass of finished wine · Fermented and aged entirely in new French oak barrels

TASTING NOTES

Red-gold color; roasted chestnut, autumn leaves, and dark bitter honey, with tarte tatin, baked custard, aniseed, and a very long, spice-laced finish.

WINERY PROFILE

The undisputed First Growth of Sauternes, farmed continuously since 1593; acquired by LVMH in 1999 — the same year as this vintage.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

100 hectares under vine. Pickers walk the rows repeatedly over weeks, harvesting only berries that have individually reached the ideal stage of noble rot — sometimes grape by grape rather than by bunch. The selection is so strict that in vintages where botrytis and ripeness don't align (as in 1992, 2012, and several others), no Grand Vin is produced at all and the crop is sold off anonymously.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

One of the world's most collectible white wines — Yquem holds the record for the most expensive bottle of white wine ever sold at auction (an 1811 vintage, \$117,000).

VINTAGE DETAILS

The 1999 shows beautifully 25 years on, with decades of life still ahead.

Pineau des Charentes — Lheraud, 'Très Vieux' | \$60

1962 · Cognac, France

Grapes: Primarily Ugni Blanc

Method: Fresh, unfermented grape must is blended directly with young Cognac eau-de-vie — stopping fermentation before it ever starts, rather than partway through as with a Vin Doux Naturel · Aged for decades in French oak

TASTING NOTES

Deep amber; dried nuts, walnut, raisin, and candied orange, with rancio complexity, a silky texture, and a long, warming finish.

WINERY PROFILE

The Lhéraud family has farmed the same Charente vineyards since 1680; Guy Lhéraud began bottling Cognac and Pineau under his own name in 1970.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

This is a mistelle, not a fermented wine in the traditional sense: grape must never begins converting sugar to alcohol because Cognac is added immediately, preserving the fruit's full natural sweetness. Decades of oak aging then build the dried-fruit, nut, and rancio complexity that a young Pineau simply can't have. "Très Vieux" denotes a legal minimum of 10 years — this bottling has rested more than six times that.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

A rare 1962 vintage bottling — one of the oldest expressions of the Charente region's signature vin de liqueur.

VINTAGE DETAILS

1962 fruit, aged over 60 years, showing the deep rancio and dried-fruit complexity only extreme age can produce.

Port — Kopke, 30 Year Tawny | \$38

Douro Valley, Portugal

Grapes: Touriga Nacional, Touriga Franca, Tinta Roriz

Method: Grapes foot-trodden or mechanically macerated in lagares (shallow fermentation tanks) at controlled temperature until partial fermentation; fortified mid-ferment with grape brandy to arrest fermentation and lock in sweetness · Aged in oak casks, blending many vintages together — the "30 Years" on the label is the official, audited average age of every wine in the blend, not a single vintage's age

TASTING NOTES

Amber with green hues; intense dried fruit, vanilla, and honey on the nose; harmonious, concentrated, and unctuous on the palate with a long finish.

WINERY PROFILE

Founded in 1638 by German diplomat Cristiano Kopke, the House is recognized as the oldest Port company in the world, sourcing fruit from its historic Quinta de São Luiz estate.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Hand-picked grapes are destemmed, crushed, and fermented with constant pumping-over to extract color and tannin, until fortification is added at the desired sweetness (baumé). Unlike Vintage Port, which matures in bottle, Tawny ages in relatively small oak casks that let in steady, controlled oxygen — over decades this softens the tannins and turns the wine amber-brown, developing dried-fruit, nut, and caramel notes in place of Vintage Port's dark fruit and structure.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

An aged Tawny built from Kopke's deep cellar reserves — the average-age labeling system allows blending across decades for a style with no single-vintage identity.

VINTAGE DETAILS

A non-vintage blend; the "30 Years Old" designation reflects an official, audited average-age certification.

Port — Warre's | \$40

1994 · Douro Valley, Portugal

Grapes: Touriga Nacional, Touriga Franca, Tinta Roriz, Tinto Cão

Method: Grapes foot-trodden in stone lagares to extract deep color and tannin over 2–3 days; fermentation stopped partway by fortifying with grape brandy (aguardente) at roughly 77% of the volume, retaining the grapes' natural sugar as sweetness · Aged about 2 years in large oak vats, then bottled unfiltered — from there it matures slowly and reductively in the bottle itself, not in wood

TASTING NOTES

Opaque purple-ruby; peppery, licorice-scented raspberry and blackcurrant fruit, with dark chocolate, cedar, and violet — full-bodied with firm, well-integrated tannins.

WINERY PROFILE

Warre's, founded in 1670, is the oldest British Port house, known for a drier, more structured house style; now part of the Symington family portfolio.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Fruit sourced from top Douro quintas including Quinta da Cavadinha. Because this is a declared Vintage Port — only produced in the best years, unlike Tawny's yearly blending — nearly all of its aging and development happens sealed in the bottle over decades, throwing heavy sediment along the way and requiring careful decanting before serving.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

1994 was a widely and enthusiastically "declared" vintage across the Douro — Wine Spectator called it one of the best of the 20th century.

VINTAGE DETAILS

Now over 30 years old and entering a long peak drinking window.

Madeira — The Rare Wine Co, Boston Bual | \$25

Madeira, Portugal

Grapes: 85% Bual, 15% very old Tinta Negra Mole

Method: Bual grapes fermented to 40–60 g/L residual sugar before fortification with grape brandy; aged by the canteiro method — barrels stored in the naturally warm upper floors of the wine lodge, where seasonal heat (not artificial heating) slowly cooks and oxidizes the wine over many years, the same process used for the island's finest, most age-worthy Madeiras

TASTING NOTES

Light amber-tawny; dried fig, walnut, maple syrup, and mahogany, with cinnamon-clove spice and citrus peel; long, dry finish balanced by vibrant acidity.

WINERY PROFILE

A collaboration between importer The Rare Wine Co. and Barbeito's Ricardo Freitas, named for Boston's historic 18th-century love of sweeter Madeiras.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

85% of the blend is Bual aged 10–20 years under canteiro; the remaining 15% is very old Tinta Negra Mole (40–60 years old), added specifically to lend the depth and complexity of a true vintage Madeira to what is otherwise a non-vintage bottling — a blending trick unique to Barbeito's approach.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

Part of The Rare Wine Co.'s Historic Series, each wine named for an American port city — Madeira was America's most fashionable wine in the 18th and 19th centuries.

VINTAGE DETAILS

A non-vintage blend, widely praised by critics as a benchmark, richer-style Madeira.

Madeira — Barbeito, Sercial Reserva Velha | \$175/oz

1898 · Madeira, Portugal

Grapes: 100% Sercial

Method: Canteiro aging — casks are physically moved through the wine lodge's upper floors over years so the wine experiences the natural warmth and cooling of the seasons, rather than the fast, artificial heat-tank process (estufagem) used for everyday Madeira · Bottled as a Frasqueira: a single-vintage, single-grape wine that, by law, must age at least 20 years before release — this one rested well over a century

TASTING NOTES

Pale amber-gold; classic Sercial profile of nuts, orange peel, and mineral salinity, with bracing, palate-cleansing acidity and an extremely long, dry finish.

WINERY PROFILE

Vinhos Barbeito, founded by Mário de Vasconcelos and still family-run, is celebrated for pure, unadulterated Madeiras made without caramel coloring — called "the established star" of the island by Jancis Robinson.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Sercial is grown at Madeira's highest elevations specifically for maximum acidity, since it's the driest and most age-worthy of the island's classic grapes. Barbeito is also known for never adding caramel coloring, unlike most Madeira houses — meaning the wine's deep amber-gold hue here comes entirely from over a century of real oxidative aging, not additives.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

An 1898 vintage is exceptionally rare — one of the oldest wines on the list, offered as a rare 1oz pour given its scarcity and value.

VINTAGE DETAILS

At over 125 years of age, this is a museum-piece Madeira, capable of near-indefinite aging once opened.

Madeira — Cossart Gordon, Bual Solera | \$160/oz

1845 · Madeira, Portugal

Grapes: 100% Bual (Boal)

Method: A true solera system — a fractional blending method rare in Madeira (more common in Sherry): a portion of wine is periodically drawn off and replaced with younger wine, so no single bottle is entirely from 1845, yet a trace of the founding vintage runs through every bottling since · Aged continuously in cask since the solera was established in 1875

TASTING NOTES

Deep mahogany with golden highlights; dried fig, date, raisin, candied citrus, caramel, and toffee, with clove and cinnamon spice and a long, smoky-oak finish.

WINERY PROFILE

Cossart Gordon, founded in 1745 by Scottish brothers Francis and Thomas Newton, is the oldest company in the Madeira trade; today part of the Madeira Wine Company alongside Blandy's.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

The 1845 Bual was converted into a solera in 1875 to help cope with the wine shortage caused by the Phylloxera epidemic, which had devastated Madeira's vineyards. Because a solera continually refreshes itself with younger wine, it can theoretically run forever — this one has been kept alive for approximately 150 years and became Cossart Gordon's first "Centenary" bottling, marking the house's 1745 founding.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

A true solera — meaning only a portion of any given bottle is actually from 1845, with wine continually added and refreshed over generations, yet the character of the founding vintage carries through.

VINTAGE DETAILS

A rare opportunity to taste a continuously-running 19th-century solera.

Madeira — Barbeito, Malvasia Reserva Velha | \$215/oz

1834 · Madeira, Portugal

Grapes: 100% Malvasia (Malmsey)

Method: Canteiro aging for well over a century — decades of natural seasonal heating and cooling inside the wine lodge, rather than artificial estufagem heat-tanks · Bottled as a Frasqueira, meaning this is genuinely, entirely 1834 fruit — unlike a solera, nothing has been blended in or refreshed since

TASTING NOTES

Refulgent amber; marmalade, lanolin, toffee apple, dried herbs, and burnt toast, with walnut, lemongrass, ginger, and white pepper through a beautifully balanced, deeply persistent finish.

WINERY PROFILE

Vinhos Barbeito, still run by the founding de Vasconcelos family, sourced this bottle from the historic Acciaioly cellar tranche — one of the rarest surviving lots of 19th-century Madeira.

FARMING & WINEMAKING

Malvasia (Malmsey) is the richest and sweetest of Madeira's four classic grapes, traditionally grown on trellises closer to sea level than drier varieties like Sercial. This bottle's cask spent nearly two centuries in the lodge before bottling, developing extraordinary depth while Madeira's signature acidity — preserved by the island's slow oxidative aging process — keeps the wine lively rather than cloying.

ABOUT THE CUVÉE

At nearly two centuries old, this is very likely the oldest wine on the list — a true museum pour, offered by the ounce given its rarity and value.

VINTAGE DETAILS

The 1834 vintage; recent tasting notes describe a wine still "in full bloom," with decades of life remaining despite its age.

SERVER STUDY GUIDE

Quiz Sheet — Questions Only

SPARKLING

Cava — Avinyó, 'Reserva Brut' | 2022

1. What are the three grapes that make up this Cava, and what characteristic does each one add?
2. What certification did this producer earn in 2022, and how many other Cava producers hold it?
3. How long has the Esteve family farmed this land, and what generation are they on?
4. How long is this wine aged on the lees, and what does that aging give the wine?

Champagne — Michel Gonet, 'Les 3 Terroirs' Blanc de Blancs Extra Brut | 2020

1. What grape is this Champagne made from, and what three flavors come specifically from its extended lees aging?
2. What are the three vineyard sites in this blend, and what does each contribute?
3. How many generations has the Gonet family owned this house, and who runs it today?
4. What is the dosage level of this wine, and what style does that make it?

Rosé Champagne — Laurent-Perrier, 'Cuvée Rosé' Brut | NV

1. What grape makes up this rosé Champagne, and what winemaking method gives it its pink color?
2. How many Grand Cru villages source the fruit for this wine, and name two of them.
3. Who created this cuvée, in what year, and what category did it start?
4. What sales distinction does this wine hold today?

Champagne — Laurent-Perrier, 'Ultra Brut' Brut Nature | NV

1. What two grapes make up this Champagne, and roughly what percentage of each?
2. How much dosage (added sugar) does this wine have, and what does that make its taste style?
3. What year was this style introduced, and what older house tradition does it revive?
4. How many crus make up this blend, and how long does it rest on the lees?

Champagne — Laurent-Perrier, 'Grand Siècle No. 26' Brut | NV (2012, 2008, 2007)

1. What two grapes make up this wine, and which one is the majority?
2. What three vintages are blended into this release, and in what proportions?
3. How many Grand Cru villages source the fruit for this wine?
4. What is this cuvée named after, and what distinctive bottle design does it use?

WHITE

Muscadet — Luneau-Papin, 'La Grange' | 2023

1. What grape is this Muscadet made from, and what mineral flavor is it especially known for?
2. How many generations has the Luneau family farmed this land, and since when?
3. What two certifications does this estate hold?
4. How does La Grange differ in style from the estate's other village wine, Le Verger?

Sancerre — Pascal & Nicolas Reverdy, 'Les Côtes' | 2025

1. What grape is this Sancerre made from, and what makes its texture different from typical Sancerre?

2. What soil type are the vines grown on, and what famous village shares this same soil?
3. Where did the two sons of the family train, and at what estates?
4. What yield restriction does this cuvée follow?

Albariño — Manuel Moldes, 'Afelio' | 2024

1. What grape is this wine made from, and what three flavors define its nose?
2. What soil type is this specific bottling grown on, and what does it contrast with in the winemaker's range?
3. What is the winemaker's nickname, and what other winery does he work for?
4. How old are the vines, and what traditional trellis system are they grown on?

Chenin Blanc — François Chidaine, 'Les Argiles' | 2024

1. What grape is this wine made from, and what two textural notes stand out on the nose?
2. Why is this wine labeled "Vin de France" instead of Vouvray?
3. How large is the domaine today, versus when Chidaine inherited it in 1989?
4. What recognition has Chidaine received from La Revue du Vin de France?

Chablis — Clément Lavallée, '45°' | 2023

1. What grape is this Chablis made from, and what does the name "45°" refer to?
2. What vessel is this wine aged in, and why does that matter for its style?
3. What two famous estates did Clément Lavallée work at before launching his own label?
4. Who are Lavallée's notable winemaking neighbors in Courgis?

ROSÉ

Rosé — Ameztoi, 'Rubentis' Getariako Txakolina | 2025

1. What two grapes make up this wine, and in what proportion?
2. Is the fizz in this wine natural or added, and how is it created?
3. What category did this specific wine pioneer, and in what decade?
4. How old are some of the red grape vines used in this wine?

Rosé — Chêne Bleu, 'Le Rosé' Vaucluse | 2024

1. What four grapes make up this rosé, and which one is the majority?
2. What elevation is this vineyard at, and what distinction does that give it in the southern Rhône?
3. What historic building once stood on this property, and who owned it?
4. What wine did Decanter compare this to?

RED

Garnacha — Vitícola Mentrídana, 'El Mentrídano' | 2022

1. What grape is this wine made from, and what makes its style "more Burgundian than Spanish"?
2. What elevation are the old vines grown at, and on what soil type?
3. Whose vineyards does this project continue, and who runs it today?
4. How does this bottling compare to the estate's higher-end cuvées?

Pinot Noir — Faiveley, 'Les Montrozières' Nuits-Saint-Georges | 2022

1. What grape is this wine made from, and what neighboring village's style does it lean toward?
2. How many hectares does Faiveley farm in total, and how many Grands Crus do they own?
3. What two previously separate parcel bottlings now make up this single cuvée?
4. What two critic scores has this wine received?

Châteauneuf-du-Pape — Croze-Granier, 'Ancien Domaine de Pontifès' | 2023

1. What two grapes make up this wine, and roughly what percentage of each?
2. What does the estate's name, "Ancien Domaine des Pontifes," historically reference?
3. Where is the cellar located, and what unique feature gives it thermal stability?
4. Since what year has this family produced wine here, and what generation are they on?

Bordeaux — Vieux Château Champs de Mars | 2003

1. What two grapes make up this wine, and roughly what percentage of each?
2. What made 2003 a distinctive vintage across France, and how did Merlot respond on the right bank?
3. Who founded this estate, and what winemaking philosophy did he pioneer at a time when Bordeaux was moving the opposite direction?
4. What neighboring, well-known estate shares a philosophy and friendship with this one?

Tempranillo — Vizcarra, 'Senda del Oro' | 2024

1. What grape is this wine made from, and what is its local Ribera del Duero name?
2. What elevation and subzone is this vineyard located in, within Ribera del Duero?
3. What adjustments did the winemakers make for the warm 2024 vintage, and why?
4. Who runs this estate today?

DESSERT WINE

Rivesaltes Ambré — Domaine de Rancý | 2000

1. What grape is this wine made from, and how does it develop its deep amber color?
2. What French winemaking technique stops fermentation and preserves the wine's natural sweetness?
3. What makes Domaine de Rancý unusual among Roussillon producers?
4. How long was this specific wine aged before bottling?

Sauternes — Château Rieussec | 2009

1. What three grapes make up this Sauternes, and which one dominates?
2. What natural phenomenon gives Sauternes its concentrated sweetness?
3. Who owns Château Rieussec today, and how prestigious is the estate within Sauternes?
4. How is the fruit harvested to capture the right level of botrytis?

Sauternes — Château d'Yquem | 1999

1. What two grapes make up this wine, and roughly what percentage of each?
2. How much wine does a single Yquem vine typically produce?
3. What company acquired Château d'Yquem, and in what year — the same year as this vintage?
4. What happens in vintages where botrytis and ripeness don't align?

Pineau des Charentes — Lheraud, 'Très Vieux' | 1962

1. What grape is this wine primarily made from?
2. What makes a Pineau des Charentes different from a fermented wine like Sauternes or Rivesaltes?
3. How long has the Lhéraud family farmed in the Charente region?
4. What does "Très Vieux" mean, and how does this bottling compare?

Port — Kopke, 30 Year Tawny

1. What three grapes typically make up this Port?
2. What does the "30 Years" on the label actually mean?
3. What makes Kopke historically significant?
4. How does Tawny Port's aging process differ from Vintage Port's?

Port — Warre's | 1994

1. What grapes typically make up this Vintage Port?
2. What makes a Vintage Port different from a Tawny?
3. How was 1994 regarded as a Port vintage?
4. What house produces this wine, and what's distinctive about its style?

Madeira — The Rare Wine Co, Boston Bual

1. What two grapes make up this Madeira, and in what proportion?
2. What aging method gives this wine its complexity, and how does it differ from cheaper Madeira production?
3. Why is this wine named "Boston"?
4. Why is old Tinta Negra Mole blended into an otherwise Bual wine?

Madeira — Barbeito, Sercial Reserva Velha | 1898

1. What grape is this wine made from, and what makes it the driest Madeira style?
2. What Portuguese term describes this wine's natural, decades-long aging process?
3. What does it mean for a Madeira to be classified as a "Frasqueira"?
4. What is unusual about Barbeito's approach to color in their wines?

Madeira — Cossart Gordon, Bual Solera | 1845

1. What grape is this wine made from?
2. What is a "solera," and how does it apply to this wine?
3. Why was this solera originally created in 1875?
4. What distinction does Cossart Gordon hold in the Madeira trade?

Madeira — Barbeito, Malvasia Reserva Velha | 1834

1. What grape is this wine made from, and what style does it represent?
2. How does this wine differ from the Cossart Gordon Solera in terms of what's actually in the bottle?
3. Roughly how old is this wine?
4. What family still runs the estate that produced this wine?

ANSWER KEY

Matches the Study Guide numbering above

SPARKLING

Cava — Avinyó, 'Reserva Brut' | 2022

- 1. What are the three grapes that make up this Cava, and what characteristic does each one add?**
Xarel·lo (60%) adds backbone and earthiness; Macabeo (25%) adds floral lift; Parellada (15%) adds acidity and elegance.
- 2. What certification did this producer earn in 2022, and how many other Cava producers hold it?**
The Elaborador Integral designation — Cava's equivalent of Récoltant-Manipulant — held by only 14 producers total in the D.O.
- 3. How long has the Esteve family farmed this land, and what generation are they on?**
Since 1597 — now the 4th generation.
- 4. How long is this wine aged on the lees, and what does that aging give the wine?**
18–24 months on the lees, giving it a creamy texture, fine mousse, and toasted brioche notes.

Champagne — Michel Gonet, 'Les 3 Terroirs' Blanc de Blancs Extra Brut | 2020

- 1. What grape is this Champagne made from, and what three flavors come specifically from its extended lees aging?**
100% Chardonnay; extended lees aging gives it hazelnut, toasted almond, and brioche notes.
- 2. What are the three vineyard sites in this blend, and what does each contribute?**
Le Mesnil sur Oger (Grand Cru chalk, tension), Montgueux (cool, citrus-driven), and Vindey in the Sézannais (rounder, fleshier texture).
- 3. How many generations has the Gonet family owned this house, and who runs it today?**
7 generations — founded in 1802, now run by Sophie Gonet.
- 4. What is the dosage level of this wine, and what style does that make it?**
2 g/L — very low, keeping the wine precise and mineral (a Blanc de Blancs Extra Brut).

Rosé Champagne — Laurent-Perrier, 'Cuvée Rosé' Brut | NV

- 1. What grape makes up this rosé Champagne, and what winemaking method gives it its pink color?**
100% Pinot Noir; the color comes from saignée maceration — 48–72 hours of skin contact before pressing.
- 2. How many Grand Cru villages source the fruit for this wine, and name two of them.**
10 Grand Cru villages, including Bouzy and Ambonnay (also Louvois and Tours-sur-Marne).
- 3. Who created this cuvée, in what year, and what category did it start?**
Bernard de Nonancourt, in 1968; it started the modern rosé Champagne category.
- 4. What sales distinction does this wine hold today?**
It's the world's best-selling rosé Champagne.

Champagne — Laurent-Perrier, 'Ultra Brut' Brut Nature | NV

- 1. What two grapes make up this Champagne, and roughly what percentage of each?**
~55% Chardonnay, 45% Pinot Noir.
- 2. How much dosage (added sugar) does this wine have, and what does that make its taste style?**
Zero dosage — completely dry, showing pure grape and chalk character with no sweetness.
- 3. What year was this style introduced, and what older house tradition does it revive?**
Introduced in 1981; it revives the 1889 'Grand Vin Sans Sucre' style, originally made for British clients.
- 4. How many crus make up this blend, and how long does it rest on the lees?**
15 Grand and Premier Cru crus; at least 6 years on the lees.

Champagne — Laurent-Perrier, 'Grand Siècle No. 26' Brut | NV (2012, 2008, 2007)

- 1. What two grapes make up this wine, and which one is the majority?**
58% Chardonnay, 42% Pinot Noir — Chardonnay-dominant.
- 2. What three vintages are blended into this release, and in what proportions?**
65% 2012, 25% 2008, 10% 2007.
- 3. How many Grand Cru villages source the fruit for this wine?**
Eight.
- 4. What is this cuvée named after, and what distinctive bottle design does it use?**
Named for Louis XIV's 'Grand Siècle' (Great Century); bottled in a replica 17th-century flask.

WHITE

Muscadet — Luneau-Papin, 'La Grange' | 2023

- 1. What grape is this Muscadet made from, and what mineral flavor is it especially known for?**
100% Melon de Bourgogne; known for crushed oyster shell and wet stone minerality.
- 2. How many generations has the Luneau family farmed this land, and since when?**
9 generations, since the late 1600s.
- 3. What two certifications does this estate hold?**
Certified organic (Ecocert) and certified biodynamic (Demeter & Biodyvin).
- 4. How does La Grange differ in style from the estate's other village wine, Le Verger?**
La Grange is rounder and fleshier; Le Verger is firmer and more linear.

Sancerre — Pascal & Nicolas Reverdy, 'Les Côûtes' | 2025

- 1. What grape is this Sancerre made from, and what makes its texture different from typical Sancerre?**
100% Sauvignon Blanc; it's noted as unusually dense and full-bodied for the appellation.
- 2. What soil type are the vines grown on, and what famous village shares this same soil?**
Kimmeridgian Marne (Terre Blanche) — the same bedrock as Chavignol.
- 3. Where did the two sons of the family train, and at what estates?**
Victorien trained at Domaine Rousseau; Benjamin trained at Romanée-Conti.
- 4. What yield restriction does this cuvée follow?**
Restricted to 45 hl/ha.

Albariño — Manuel Moldes, 'Afelio' | 2024

- 1. What grape is this wine made from, and what three flavors define its nose?**
100% Albariño; salt spray, white peach, and lemon define the nose.
- 2. What soil type is this specific bottling grown on, and what does it contrast with in the winemaker's range?**
Granite bedrock — contrasts with his schist-based bottlings.
- 3. What is the winemaker's nickname, and what other winery does he work for?**
"Chicho" — he's also the winemaker at Bodegas Fulcro.
- 4. How old are the vines, and what traditional trellis system are they grown on?**
50+ years old, on the traditional pergola system on granite posts.

Chenin Blanc — François Chidaine, 'Les Argiles' | 2024

- 1. What grape is this wine made from, and what two textural notes stand out on the nose?**
100% Chenin Blanc; beeswax and fresh cream stand out on the nose.
- 2. Why is this wine labeled "Vin de France" instead of Vouvray?**
Because Chidaine's cellar is in neighboring Montlouis, and the Vouvray AOC has barred him from using the Vouvray name since 2014.
- 3. How large is the domaine today, versus when Chidaine inherited it in 1989?**
45 hectares today, up from just 4 hectares in 1989.

4. What recognition has Chidaine received from La Revue du Vin de France?

He holds the highest rating of any Loire Valley producer — one of only seven to hold it.

Chablis — Clément Lavallée, '45°' | 2023

1. What grape is this Chablis made from, and what does the name "45°" refer to?

100% Chardonnay; "45°" refers to the 45-degree slope of the vineyard the grapes come from.

2. What vessel is this wine aged in, and why does that matter for its style?

Stainless steel — not oak — for 18 months, preserving the site's pure mineral character without oxidative influence.

3. What two famous estates did Clément Lavallée work at before launching his own label?

Château Margaux and Armand Heitz (also Domaine Chapoutier and Rutherglen, Australia).

4. Who are Lavallée's notable winemaking neighbors in Courgis?

Thomas Pico of Pattes Loup and Domaine De Moor.

ROSÉ

Rosé — Ameztoi, 'Rubentis' Getariako Txakolina | 2025

1. What two grapes make up this wine, and in what proportion?

A 50/50 field blend of Hondarribi Beltza and Hondarribi Zuri.

2. Is the fizz in this wine natural or added, and how is it created?

Natural — bottle-conditioned residual CO₂ from fermentation, never force-carbonated.

3. What category did this specific wine pioneer, and in what decade?

It was the first rosé Txakoli ever produced, in the 2000s.

4. How old are some of the red grape vines used in this wine?

Some Hondarribi Beltza vines date back to 1840.

Rosé — Chêne Bleu, 'Le Rosé' Vaucluse | 2024

1. What four grapes make up this rosé, and which one is the majority?

60% Grenache, 20% Syrah, 14% Mourvèdre, 6% Rolle (Vermentino) — Grenache-dominant.

2. What elevation is this vineyard at, and what distinction does that give it in the southern Rhône?

530–630 meters — the highest vineyard in the southern Rhône.

3. What historic building once stood on this property, and who owned it?

A medieval priory once owned by the Knights Templar.

4. What wine did Decanter compare this to?

Domaine Tempier Bandol.

RED

Garnacha — Vitícola Mentrídana, 'El Mentrídano' | 2022

1. What grape is this wine made from, and what makes its style "more Burgundian than Spanish"?

100% Garnacha; its light body, delicate tannins, and floral character make it feel more Burgundian than a typical bold Spanish red.

2. What elevation are the old vines grown at, and on what soil type?

600 meters, on sandy granitic soils.

3. Whose vineyards does this project continue, and who runs it today?

Continues the vineyards of Daniel Landi of Comando G; run today by his childhood friend, Curro Barreño.

4. How does this bottling compare to the estate's higher-end cuvées?

It's more accessible and drinkable than the higher-altitude Las Uvas de la Ira (850m) and the single-vineyard Cantos del Diablo.

Pinot Noir — Faiveley, 'Les Montrozier' Nuits-Saint-Georges | 2022

- 1. What grape is this wine made from, and what neighboring village's style does it lean toward?**
100% Pinot Noir; it leans toward the elegance of neighboring Vosne-Romanée rather than typical Nuits-Saint-Georges.
- 2. How many hectares does Faiveley farm in total, and how many Grands Crus do they own?**
120 hectares, including 12 Grands Crus.
- 3. What two previously separate parcel bottlings now make up this single cuvée?**
Aux Lavières and Les Argillats.
- 4. What two critic scores has this wine received?**
91 points from Wine Advocate and 92 points from Jasper Morris.

Châteauneuf-du-Pape — Croze-Granier, 'Ancien Domaine de Pontifès' | 2023

- 1. What two grapes make up this wine, and roughly what percentage of each?**
~80% Grenache, ~20% Mourvèdre.
- 2. What does the estate's name, "Ancien Domaine des Pontifes," historically reference?**
The property's historic ties to the Avignon papacy.
- 3. Where is the cellar located, and what unique feature gives it thermal stability?**
Roquemaure, built into a stone cliff (L'Escatillon).
- 4. Since what year has this family produced wine here, and what generation are they on?**
Since 1895 — 5th generation.

Bordeaux — Vieux Château Champs de Mars | 2003

- 1. What two grapes make up this wine, and roughly what percentage of each?**
80% Merlot, 20% Cabernet Franc.
- 2. What made 2003 a distinctive vintage across France, and how did Merlot respond on the right bank?**
2003 was the heat-wave vintage across France; Merlot handled the extreme heat well, producing concentrated, plush wines.
- 3. Who founded this estate, and what winemaking philosophy did he pioneer at a time when Bordeaux was moving the opposite direction?**
Régis Moro, in the early 1980s; he farmed organically and used low-intervention cellar work.
- 4. What neighboring, well-known estate shares a philosophy and friendship with this one?**
Château Le Puy — whose owners, the Amoreau family, eventually acquired Champs de Mars.

Tempranillo — Vizcarra, 'Senda del Oro' | 2024

- 1. What grape is this wine made from, and what is its local Ribera del Duero name?**
100% Tempranillo, locally called Tinto Fino.
- 2. What elevation and subzone is this vineyard located in, within Ribera del Duero?**
Mambrilla de Castrejón, in the Burgos subzone — the highest and coolest part of the region, at 800–850m.
- 3. What adjustments did the winemakers make for the warm 2024 vintage, and why?**
They picked earlier and used shorter macerations to preserve freshness and acidity.
- 4. Who runs this estate today?**
A father-daughter team — Juan Carlos Vizcarra and his daughter Celia.

DESSERT WINE

Rivesaltes Ambré — Domaine de Rancý | 2000

- 1. What grape is this wine made from, and how does it develop its deep amber color?**
100% Macabeu; the amber color and dried-fruit, caramel character come from 21 years of deliberate barrel oxidation.
- 2. What French winemaking technique stops fermentation and preserves the wine's natural sweetness?**
Mutage — fortifying the wine with neutral grape spirit partway through fermentation to kill the yeast.
- 3. What makes Domaine de Rancý unusual among Roussillon producers?**

They're one of only a handful of estates still making traditional Ambré-style Rivesaltes, deliberately aging the wine oxidatively for decades.

4. How long was this specific wine aged before bottling?

21 years in oak, bottled in 2021.

Sauternes — Château Rieussec | 2009

1. What three grapes make up this Sauternes, and which one dominates?

~90% Sémillon, ~7% Sauvignon Blanc, ~3% Muscadelle — Sémillon-dominant.

2. What natural phenomenon gives Sauternes its concentrated sweetness?

Botrytis cinerea, or "noble rot," which shrivels the grapes and concentrates their sugar.

3. Who owns Château Rieussec today, and how prestigious is the estate within Sauternes?

Domaines Baron de Rothschild (Lafite), since 1984; it's one of the largest and most prestigious Sauternes estates, second only to Château d'Yquem.

4. How is the fruit harvested to capture the right level of botrytis?

Pickers make several passes (tries) through the vineyard over 6–8 weeks, hand-selecting only individually shriveled berries.

Sauternes — Château d'Yquem | 1999

1. What two grapes make up this wine, and roughly what percentage of each?

~80% Sémillon, ~20% Sauvignon Blanc.

2. How much wine does a single Yquem vine typically produce?

About one glass.

3. What company acquired Château d'Yquem, and in what year — the same year as this vintage?

LVMH, in 1999.

4. What happens in vintages where botrytis and ripeness don't align?

No Grand Vin is made at all — the crop is sold off anonymously to other producers.

Pineau des Charentes — Lheraud, 'Très Vieux' | 1962

1. What grape is this wine primarily made from?

Ugni Blanc.

2. What makes a Pineau des Charentes different from a fermented wine like Sauternes or Rivesaltes?

It's a mistelle — fresh grape must is blended with Cognac before fermentation ever starts, rather than stopped partway through.

3. How long has the Lhéraud family farmed in the Charente region?

Since 1680.

4. What does "Très Vieux" mean, and how does this bottling compare?

It denotes a legal minimum of 10 years aged; this 1962 bottling has rested more than six times that minimum.

Port — Kopke, 30 Year Tawny

1. What three grapes typically make up this Port?

Touriga Nacional, Touriga Franca, and Tinta Roriz.

2. What does the "30 Years" on the label actually mean?

It's the official average age of all the wines blended together — not a single vintage.

3. What makes Kopke historically significant?

Founded in 1638, it's recognized as the oldest Port house in the world.

4. How does Tawny Port's aging process differ from Vintage Port's?

Tawny ages for decades in oak casks with steady oxygen contact; Vintage Port ages mostly sealed in the bottle.

Port — Warre's | 1994

1. What grapes typically make up this Vintage Port?

Touriga Nacional, Touriga Franca, Tinta Roriz, and Tinto Cão.

2. What makes a Vintage Port different from a Tawny?

It's declared only in the best years and matures mostly in the bottle, not in wood.

3. How was 1994 regarded as a Port vintage?

It was widely and enthusiastically "declared" — Wine Spectator called it one of the best of the 20th century.

4. What house produces this wine, and what's distinctive about its style?

Warre's, the oldest British Port house (founded 1670), known for a drier, more structured style.

Madeira — The Rare Wine Co, Boston Bual

1. What two grapes make up this Madeira, and in what proportion?

85% Bual, 15% very old Tinta Negra Mole.

2. What aging method gives this wine its complexity, and how does it differ from cheaper Madeira production?

The canteiro method — barrels rest in the naturally warm upper floors of the wine lodge over years, rather than being quickly heated in tanks (estufagem).

3. Why is this wine named "Boston"?

It's part of a series honoring American port cities where Madeira was historically popular — Boston favored sweeter styles like Bual.

4. Why is old Tinta Negra Mole blended into an otherwise Bual wine?

To lend the depth and complexity of a true vintage Madeira to an otherwise non-vintage bottling.

Madeira — Barbeito, Sercial Reserva Velha | 1898

1. What grape is this wine made from, and what makes it the driest Madeira style?

100% Sercial — grown at high elevation for maximum acidity, producing Madeira's driest, most age-worthy wines.

2. What Portuguese term describes this wine's natural, decades-long aging process?

Canteiro — barrels are moved through the lodge to experience natural seasonal warmth and cooling.

3. What does it mean for a Madeira to be classified as a "Frasqueira"?

A single-vintage, single-grape wine legally required to age at least 20 years before release.

4. What is unusual about Barbeito's approach to color in their wines?

They never add caramel coloring — the deep amber-gold color here comes entirely from over a century of real aging.

Madeira — Cossart Gordon, Bual Solera | 1845

1. What grape is this wine made from?

100% Bual (Boal).

2. What is a "solera," and how does it apply to this wine?

A fractional blending system where wine is periodically drawn off and replaced with younger wine — so a trace of the founding 1845 vintage still runs through every bottle.

3. Why was this solera originally created in 1875?

To help cope with the wine shortage caused by the Phylloxera epidemic.

4. What distinction does Cossart Gordon hold in the Madeira trade?

Founded in 1745, it's the oldest company in the Madeira trade.

Madeira — Barbeito, Malvasia Reserva Velha | 1834

1. What grape is this wine made from, and what style does it represent?

100% Malvasia (Malmsey) — the richest and sweetest of Madeira's classic grapes.

2. How does this wine differ from the Cossart Gordon Solera in terms of what's actually in the bottle?

This is a true Frasqueira — entirely 1834 fruit, with nothing blended in or refreshed, unlike a solera.

3. Roughly how old is this wine?

Nearly two centuries old, from 1834.

4. What family still runs the estate that produced this wine?

The de Vasconcelos family, who founded Vinhos Barbeito.